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Business Outcome Framework

Stop selling features. Start solving business problems. Six outcomes that define the value we deliver — in our clients' language.

DRAFT

Last updated: February 24, 2026

Why Outcomes, Not Features

No client wakes up thinking "I need a cybersecurity assessment." They wake up thinking "How do I keep my investors confident?" or "How do I make sure we pass our next SEC exam?" or "How do I protect what we've built?"

When we talk about features and deliverables — assessments, policies, monitoring — we're speaking *our* language. When we talk about outcomes — capital confidence, regulatory readiness, operational resilience — we're speaking *their* language. The shift is subtle but powerful: it moves us from vendor to strategic partner.

This framework defines **six business outcomes** that every Drawbridge engagement should map to. Use them in renewal conversations, QBRs, proposals, and internal planning.

💡 **How to Use This Framework**

In renewal conversations: "This year, we helped you achieve [Outcome] by [specific evidence]. Here's how we'll continue driving that value next year."

In proposals: Lead with the outcome, then explain how specific services deliver it. Not "we'll provide 4 assessments and 12 policy reviews" — instead, "we'll ensure you're exam-ready year-round, which includes..."

In QBRs: Organize the review around outcomes, not task lists. Show progress against each outcome with evidence and metrics.

In your client's language: Every outcome below includes a "how your client says it" section. Listen for these phrases — they're buying signals that map directly to an outcome you can solve.

The Six Outcomes

1
Raise & Retain Capital with Confidence
Investor trust through operational excellence

2
Navigate Regulatory Complexity
Stay ahead of evolving regulations

3
Protect the Firm from Disruption
Be ready for the incident that hasn't happened yet

4
Make Security a Competitive Advantage
Turn a cost center into a differentiator

5
Scale Without Adding Headcount
Enterprise security without the enterprise team

6
Get AI-Ready, Stay AI-Safe
Adopt AI with confidence — training, assessments & governance

1

Raise & Retain Capital with Confidence

Investor trust is earned through operational excellence — not just performance.

WHY IT MATTERS

Allocators commit capital to managers they trust — and trust increasingly requires demonstrating operational and cybersecurity maturity. A single failed DDQ response, an incomplete ODD review, or a data breach headline can cost a firm hundreds of millions in commitments. For PE firms in fundraising cycles and hedge funds with open-ended redemption structures, investor confidence is existential.

THE BUSINESS IMPACT

- Faster DDQ turnaround with higher-quality, consistent responses
- Smoother LP due diligence cycles with fewer follow-up requests
- Confidence to pursue new allocator relationships knowing the program is solid
- Reduced risk of capital loss from operational deficiency concerns

HOW YOUR CLIENT SAYS IT

"Our LPs keep asking about cybersecurity" "DDQ season is killing us" "We're raising a new fund" "Our consultant flagged our security program" "We need to look institutional"

VALUE NARRATIVES & SKU MAPPING

Coming soon — detailed narratives and service mapping will be added here.

2 Navigate Regulatory Complexity

Stay ahead of evolving regulations without building a compliance department.

WHY IT MATTERS

The regulatory landscape is expanding and accelerating — Reg S-P amendments, SEC exam priorities, DORA in Europe, state privacy laws, and new disclosure requirements. Keeping up is a full-time job that most alternative managers don't have the headcount for. The cost of non-compliance isn't just fines — it's reputational damage, LP concern, and management distraction.

THE BUSINESS IMPACT

- Exam-ready posture maintained year-round — not scrambled before a visit
- Proactive compliance with new rules before enforcement begins
- Reduced legal and consulting spend on regulatory interpretation
- Confidence that the firm won't be caught off guard by a rule change

HOW YOUR CLIENT SAYS IT

"What do the new SEC rules mean for us?" "We got an exam notification"

"Our outside counsel says we need to update our policies" "We have European investors now"

"We just want to stay out of trouble"

VALUE NARRATIVES & SKU MAPPING

Coming soon — detailed narratives and service mapping will be added here.

3 Protect the Firm from Disruption

Be ready for the incident that hasn't happened yet — and recover fast when it does.

WHY IT MATTERS

Cyber incidents aren't theoretical — they're statistical certainties. The question is not *if* but *when* and *how bad*. A ransomware attack can shut down operations for weeks. A BEC scam can move millions in minutes. A data breach can trigger regulatory action, LP redemptions, and lasting reputational harm. The firms that survive these events are the ones that prepared for them.

THE BUSINESS IMPACT

- Reduced likelihood and blast radius of security incidents
- Faster detection and response when incidents occur
- Tested recovery procedures that actually work under pressure
- Lower financial and reputational cost of incidents

HOW YOUR CLIENT SAYS IT

"What happens if we get hit?" "Our peer firm just had a breach" "We need someone to call at 2am" "We're worried about ransomware" "Do we have a plan if something happens?"

VALUE NARRATIVES & SKU MAPPING

Coming soon — detailed narratives and service mapping will be added here.

4

Make Security a Competitive Advantage

Turn a cost center into a differentiator that wins capital, talent, and trust.

WHY IT MATTERS

Most firms think of cybersecurity as a cost — something they have to do. The best-run firms think of it as a competitive weapon. In a market where allocators are choosing between managers with similar strategies and returns, the firm with the best operational infrastructure wins the allocation. A mature, well-documented security program signals professionalism, institutional quality, and respect for investor capital.

THE BUSINESS IMPACT

- Differentiation in competitive fundraising situations
- Faster LP onboarding with pre-built compliance evidence
- Ability to win larger, more sophisticated institutional allocators
- Talent attraction — top candidates want to join well-run firms

HOW YOUR CLIENT SAYS IT

"We want to look best-in-class" | "How do we compare to our peers?" | "We're going after bigger LPs" | "Our competitor just got SOC 2 certified" | "We need to level up our operations"

VALUE NARRATIVES & SKU MAPPING

Coming soon — detailed narratives and service mapping will be added here.

5 Scale Without Adding Headcount

Grow the firm, launch funds, and expand operations without building an internal security team.

WHY IT MATTERS

Alternative managers are lean by design — every headcount dollar that goes to non-investment functions is a dollar not generating alpha. But as firms grow, the security demands grow with them: more employees, more vendors, more data, more regulatory surface area. Hiring a CISO ($300K–$500K+ fully loaded) plus a security team is prohibitive for most firms. They need enterprise-grade security that scales with their business — without the enterprise headcount.

THE BUSINESS IMPACT

- Full security program at a fraction of the cost of building in-house
- Instant access to specialized expertise (IR, pen testing, regulatory) on demand
- Security that grows automatically with new funds, offices, and portfolio companies
- Free up COO / CCO time to focus on running the business

HOW YOUR CLIENT SAYS IT

"We don't have a CISO and don't want to hire one"
"Our COO is stretched thin"
"We just launched a new fund"
"We're opening a London office"
"We need this handled — I don't have the bandwidth"

VALUE NARRATIVES & SKU MAPPING

Coming soon — detailed narratives and service mapping will be added here.

6 Get AI-Ready, Stay AI-Safe

Adopt AI with confidence — with the training, assessments, and governance to minimize risk.

WHY IT MATTERS

Every firm is being asked about AI — by LPs, by regulators, and by their own teams. Employees are already using AI tools, often without oversight. The SEC is paying attention to AI governance, and allocators are starting to ask "what's your AI policy?" in DDQs. Firms that wait to address AI readiness will find themselves reacting to incidents, regulatory gaps, and reputational risk. The firms that get ahead will have clear policies, trained teams, and a framework for evaluating and governing AI tools — turning a source of anxiety into a managed capability.

THE BUSINESS IMPACT

- Employee AI training that reduces risk of data leakage and misuse
- LLM and AI tool assessments that identify exposure before it becomes a problem
- Clear, documented AI acceptable use policies that satisfy regulators and LPs
- Governance framework for evaluating, approving, and monitoring AI tools
- Confidence to adopt AI where it adds value — without creating new attack surfaces

HOW YOUR CLIENT SAYS IT

"Our team is using ChatGPT — should we be worried?"
"LPs are asking about our AI policy"
"We don't know what tools people are using"
"The SEC mentioned AI in their exam priorities"
"We want to use AI but don't know where to start"

WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE

AI Training
Role-based training on safe AI usage, data handling, and recognizing risks like prompt injection and data leakage.

LLM & Tool Assessments
Evaluate which AI tools are in use (sanctioned and shadow), assess data exposure risk, and map AI to existing risk frameworks.

Policy & Governance
Create AI acceptable use policies, approval workflows for new tools, and ongoing monitoring and review cadences.

VALUE NARRATIVES & SKU MAPPING
Coming soon — detailed narratives and service mapping will be added here.

Putting It All Together

The Outcome-Led Conversation

Here's the shift in practice. Instead of walking into a renewal and saying:

> *"This year we completed 4 assessments, updated 12 policies, ran 2 tabletop exercises, and responded to 47 DDQs. Here's the renewal for the same scope."*

You say:

> *"This year, we helped you raise your new fund with confidence — your ODD reviews went smoothly and your DDQ turnaround time dropped from 3 weeks to 5 days. We kept you exam-ready with current policies and a tested IR plan. We got ahead of AI risk with training and policies before the SEC asked about it. And we did it all without you having to hire a single security person. Looking ahead, here's how we continue driving those outcomes as you grow."*

Same services. Same deliverables. Completely different conversation. The first sounds like a vendor reporting tasks. The second sounds like a partner demonstrating impact.

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🔄 Mapping Outcomes to Client Priorities

Not every outcome matters equally to every client. Part of being a strategic advisor is knowing which outcomes to lead with based on who you're talking to:

Client Type	Lead With	Support With
Hedge Fund (fundraising)	1. Raise & Retain Capital	2. Regulatory + 4. Competitive Advantage
Hedge Fund (steady state)	2. Regulatory Complexity	3. Protection + 6. AI Readiness
PE Firm (GP level)	1. Raise & Retain Capital	5. Scale + 6. AI Readiness (portco)
PE Portfolio Company	3. Protect from Disruption	2. Regulatory + 6. AI Readiness
Family Office	3. Protect from Disruption	5. Scale (no headcount)
Firm with EU exposure	2. Regulatory (DORA)	4. Competitive Advantage
Post-incident firm	3. Protect from Disruption	1. Capital Confidence (LP recovery)
Firm adopting AI tools	6. AI Readiness	2. Regulatory + 3. Protection

📏 Measuring Outcome Delivery

Each outcome should have observable evidence. When you prepare for a QBR or renewal, gather proof points for the outcomes that matter most to that client:

1. **Capital Confidence**
   DDQs completed & avg. turnaround time, ODD reviews supported, LP-facing reports delivered, allocator retention rate

2. **Regulatory Readiness**
   Policies updated & current, exam readiness score, regulatory changes addressed, deficiency findings (zero is the goal)

3. **Protection & Resilience**
   Risk score trend, vulnerabilities identified & remediated, IR plan tested (date), incidents detected & contained, phishing test results

4. **Competitive Advantage**
   Peer benchmarking position, new capabilities implemented, certifications or frameworks achieved, LP feedback quality

5. **Scale & Efficiency**
   Cost vs. in-house equivalent, COO/CCO hours saved, new entities covered (funds, offices, portcos), services consumed per dollar

6. **AI Readiness**
   AI policy in place & current, employees trained (% completion), AI tools inventoried & assessed, shadow AI tools identified, governance review cadence established

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR DRAWBRIDGE

This framework is the foundation for how we talk about value — externally and internally. Every service we deliver, every assessment we run, every policy we write should tie back to one or more of these six outcomes. If it doesn't, we need to ask why we're doing it.

Over time, we'll build detailed value narratives under each outcome — the specific stories, data points, and proof that bring each outcome to life in client conversations. We'll also map our service catalog (SKUs) to outcomes so every proposal can be framed as "here's how we deliver Outcome X" rather than "here's a list of things we do."

Start using the framework now. Pick one client this week and reframe your next conversation around outcomes instead of deliverables. See what happens.

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